



Shall I elaborate on the growth of small and medium industry which contributes to large-scale exports and provides employment to a large number of our youth? Shall I dwell on our experience of creating PURA (Providing Urban Amenities in Rural Areas) complexes by some educational institutions and industries and transforming them into economic hubs? Shall I talk about the excellent action taken by the judiciary in several cases? Shall I describe how our IT industries are contributing to over 25 per cent of our exports through software and services? Shall I express my happiness that one in every two Indians will have a mobile phone before 2010? Shall I concentrate on describing the happiness of the youth due to the birth of a large number of IITs, IIMS, IISERS, and IIITs? Should I express my happiness about the active participation of our media, both print and electronic, in attempting to connect a billion people? Can I share how 23 million Indians living in various parts of the world are enriching those nations and India through knowledge centres and bringing glory to our motherland? Can I share the pride of our democracy being strengthened during the last six decades in spite of our multiple political systems?

No. While each of them are great accomplishments in their own way what is striking is the spirit of India that gives rise to such enthusiasm. In the 1990s, the youth always used to ask me, "When can I sing the Song of India?" Today, the youth are asking me, "What can I give to India?" This, in my opinion, represents the New Spirit of this New India. This change in the pattern of questions is representative of the transformation of the country over the years. I receive many e-mails and letters expressing the same sentiment. When I study them and also the personal interactions with people, I can clearly see the responsibility that we owe to this spirit of India. How do we do that? We need to focus on futuristic priorities in a mission mode. National leadership, irrespective of its political spectrum, should inspire confidence among our people and boldly formulate and implement development missions in a cooperative and competitive mode with specific time-bound goals, with the sole purpose of meeting the aspirations

of the Spirit of India.

To keep that spirit vibrant and self-rejuvenating, as a nation, we have to evolve a vision for India for the year 2020. The India of 2020 should be:



1 A nation where the rural and urban divide is reduced to a very thin line.



2 A nation where there is an equitable distribution of and adequate access to energy and quality water.



3 A nation where agriculture, industry and the service sector work together in symphony.



4 A nation where education with a value system is not denied to any meritorious candidates because of societal or economic discrimination.



5 A nation which is the best destination for the most talented scholars, scientists, and investors.



6 A nation where the best of healthcare is available to all.



7 A nation where governance is responsive, transparent and free of corruption.



8 A nation where poverty has been totally eradicated, illiteracy removed and crimes against women and children are absent.



9 A nation that is prosperous, healthy, secure, peaceful and happy, on a sustainable growth path.



10 A nation that is one of the best places to live in and is proud of its leadership.

We should convert this into a Mission India 2020 for a strong, prosperous and happy nation. With such a profile, as the leading driver for the political parties, they can perform in the environment of developmental politics, competing with each other in the political vision of national development and